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A gap in law on AI-created images of kids

Victim advocates demand Mass. make photos illegal

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

Editor's note: The following story contains discussions of online child sexual abuse material. If you or someone you know is the victim of such abuse, the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children offers support and resources at 1-800-843-5678.

The rooms were freshly repainted, the furniture all cleaned out. Ann's boyfriend of 18 months was hours from moving in with her and her 14-year-old daughter when he made a quick run to his storage unit. Ann had stayed back in his house to finish cleaning up the place when she spotted

his iPad on the floor. She paused. She'd been hoping for a serious relationship after a decade of raising three kids on her own. Her boyfriend was clever and good-looking, had quickly bonded with her kids, and had been spending at least three nights a week at her place. He'd taken particular interest in her youngest daughter, giving her rides to school, following her on social media, and sharing inside jokes. Ann trusted him. Her

daughter did too.

"I was really eager to have another adult in my life in every way that single moms need help," said Ann, who asked the Globe

AI IMAGES, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

A mother is working to pass a state law to make it illegal to manipulate images into child abuse photos.

Wu mulls tax breaks to spur housing

Had abandoned previous effort; developers fear abatement comes too late

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

After years of negotiating with real estate developers about ways to spur sluggish housing construction in Boston, Mayor Michelle Wu is once again considering tax breaks to help break ground on new apartment buildings. But many developers say the effort is too little, too late.

The city is considering short-term tax abatements for projects that would be able to start construction in the next 18 months, according to three Boston developers who have discussed tax breaks with the city and spoke on condition of anonymity.

While the discussions are preliminary and do not represent a formal shift in city policy, it's a notable pivot from an administration that has prioritized affordable housing above other forms of development. Boston requires one-fifth of most new market-rate buildings to be set aside as affordable and has rarely subsidized such projects in the past.

The conversations follow a period of marked decline in new housing and construction citywide, even as rents continue to rise, and come as developers fear a successful rent control ballot question would effectively freeze new residential construction.

ABATEMENTS, Page A10

Middle-class costs outpace inflation rate

Households' budget woes worsen, research reveals

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Within five years, the income needed to maintain a middle-class standard of living for a two-parent family with two school-age children in Massachusetts jumped nearly 50 percent, according to the MassINC Policy Center.

This increase, from \$117,000 in 2020 to \$174,000 in 2024, is a much faster rise than in the past and exceeds the rate nationwide.

It also outpaced the inflation rate by 28 percentage points, analysis by the Massachusetts

research nonprofit shows. Until recently, inflation rose at about the same rate as middle-class household budgets. And this divergence reflects MassINC's larger finding: Many households are far more financially strained than traditional inflation measures show.

So what's happening? Costs have been skyrocketing, to start, particularly for housing. In Massachusetts, home prices have increased more than in any other state; hous-

INFLATION, Page A6



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

CAPPING OFF A TUMULTUOUS TIME

A year to the day after ICE arrest, Milford teen graduates from high school

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

MILFORD — Marcelo Gomes da Silva grabbed his red cap and gown Sunday morning and made that same drive, the one he'll never forget.

As the graduating senior steered his family's silver Volkswagen Golf to Milford High School, he remembered the harrowing journey that began along this same route exactly one year ago. It was on May 31, 2025, that federal immigration agents pulled Gomes over on his way to volleyball practice.

Gomes's arrest did more than send him to a basement detention facility, where he



Marcelo Gomes da Silva (top, front) tossed his cap at the conclusion of his graduation ceremony at Milford High School. Gomes's 8-year-old brother, Miguel, held Marcelo's diploma (above).

spent six days crammed with dozens of men twice his age, without sunlight or a shower. It also marked a new level of aggressiveness in the Trump administration crackdown on immigrants, sparking local outrage that a high schooler with no criminal record could be seized without warning.

This year, on this day, Gomes arrived without incident at Milford High, where he was one of 280 students to stride across the turf football field to receive their diplomas on a wind-swept, sunny morning.

When they called Gomes's name, he stepped forward smiling and clapping as

MARCELO, Page A7

Local firms at vanguard of a transplant revolution

High-tech devices keep organs viable, boost odds for success

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Earlier this year, a patient in North Carolina successfully received a donated heart from a donor in California, in what's become a seemingly ordinary, though still nery, feat in the high-stakes world of organ transplants.

It wasn't that long ago that sending a critical organ such as a heart on a 2,000-mile, eight-hour plus journey across the country without supplying it with a constant flow of blood was impossible. Four to six hours max outside the body was the

limit for most surgeons.

But something of a small revolution has occurred in the field, centered around one of the more prosaic components of such a sophisticated medical operation: the traveling container that holds the donated organ.

And behind it are two companies based in Massachusetts that have developed high-tech containers which significantly extend the viability of the donor organ. The devices maintain internal temperatures and even continuously run fluid or air through the organs to keep them active while in transit.

"The increase in transplants and increase in organs that are safe for transplant because of these technologies is so profound," said Dr. Charles Strom, chief

ORGANS, Page A7

A FIREFIGHTER'S FAREWELL



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Scores of firefighters and other first-responders lined up for the wake Sunday of Robert T. Kilduff Jr. at St. Theresa of Avila Church in Boston. Kilduff died while helping fight a fire in Dorchester. **B1.**



Let 'er drip

Monday: Several showers.
High 54-59, low 47-52.

Tuesday: A few more showers.
High 67-72, low 53-58.

Sunrise: 5:10. Sunset: 8:14.
Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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